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Global Macro Commentary | North America

October 15: Balanced Beige Book

Risk fluctuates on mixed US-China trade signals, with Bessent floating pause on tariffs & export controls; balanced risks in Fed's Beige Book; strong US Empire manufacturing; US federal layoffs temporarily blocked; low USD/CNY fixing below 7.10; DXY at 98.793 (-0.3%); US 10y at 4.028 (-0.4bp).

Risk sentiment fluctuates throughout the day on US-China trade headlines, but ends the day fairly strong.

Developed Markets

- **Front-end US rates sell off after a strong Empire manufacturing survey and balanced Beige Book trim expectations for future Fed cuts.** The Empire survey rebounds strongly to 10.8 in October from -8.7 in September, a potential sign of strong manufacturing amid the lack of economic hard data. Afterwards, 2y Treasuries sell off 2bp as the market-implied probability of Fed cuts in December, January, and March decrease by ~5% each. Yields remain elevated as the Fed's Beige Book shows "economic activity changed little" last month, with similarly little change in unemployment, but more price pressures than the prior Beige Book as "district reports indicated that input costs increased at a faster pace due to higher import costs."
- **The dollar weakens and US equities rally (S&P 500: +0.4%) as risk sentiment recovers after Treasury Secretary Bessent proposes a longer pause on US tariffs on China in exchange for China delaying its rare earth export controls.** Bessent adds that neither country wants a full economic decoupling, in line with our [view](#) that the most likely outcome is another limited agreement that largely recreates the prior détente regarding export controls. However, Bessent later [suggests](#) that the World Bank end support for China, and President Trump [says](#) the US and China are in a "trade war." Defense stocks lag the equity rally (S&P Aerospace & Defense: -1.6%) after Bessent says the administration may ask defense companies to reduce stock buybacks.
- **As the US government shutdown continues to show little progress, US courts temporarily block the administration's efforts to lay off over 4,000 federal workers,** reducing the risk of larger labor market impacts after officials earlier proposed up to 10,000 layoffs. President Trump [orders](#) military employees to be paid despite the shutdown, potentially reducing near-term economic and political pressures. Prediction markets now price a 75% likelihood of the shutdown lasting longer than a month. Meanwhile, Treasury Secretary Bessent [confirms](#) prior reporting that five candidates are

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being considered for the next Fed chair, and he intends to present President Trump with three or four options in December.

- **Japanese rates twist flatten in a partial reversal of Tuesday's steepening after Nikkei reports a possible BoJ rate hike this winter.** 2y JGBs sell off 1bp as pricing for October and December rate hikes slightly recovers. Long-end JGBs rally strongly into the afternoon's 20y auction and continue to rally afterwards given that the auction is digested smoothly, with a cut-off price of 100.20. JPY strengthens 0.5% against USD as rate differentials shift in favor of Japan, while the Nikkei retraces Tuesday's weakness, gaining 1.8%.
- **European duration continues to rally on the back of Tuesday's constructive fiscal developments in France.** German bunds bull-flatten (2y: -1bp; 30y: -5bp), with more muted moves in EUR swaps. French OATs lead a continued tightening in EGB spreads. The CAC 40 rallies 2%, outperforming the Euro Stoxx 50 (+1%) as market sentiment remains positive ahead of tomorrow's no-confidence vote given that Prime Minister Lecornu gained [political support](#) following his suspension of the proposed pension reforms.
- **Among G10 currencies, NOK outperforms (NOK/USD: -0.7%) as Norway's 2026 budget comes broadly in line with expectations.** CAD underperforms the dollar weakness, with USD/CAD holding steady as Canadian rates rally 2bp despite the US sell-off and a slower-than-expected decline in manufacturing sales (-1.0% m/m; C: -1.5%). Elsewhere, AUD/USD strengthens 0.4% supported by a low USD/CNY fixing, but still lags the G10 given its exposure to US-China trade tensions.

Emerging Markets

- **AxJ currencies rally as risk appetite rebounds and the USD/CNY fixing breaks below the widely watched 7.10 level.** In China, CNH strengthens 0.2% after the release of the fixing while CNY NDIRS yields remain largely stable amid soft September inflation (-0.3% y/y; C: -0.2%) and credit growth data (RMB1290bn; C: RMB1460bn). KRW rallies 0.4% back to ~1,422 per USD alongside local equity gains (KOSPI: +2.7%), while KRW NDIRS yields remain largely stable despite the announcement of stricter-than-expected property market cooling measures.
- **India leads regional FX gains, rallying 0.8% to 88.07 per USD amid unconfirmed reports of RBI intervention,** with a wider-than-expected September trade deficit (-\$32bn; C: -\$28bn) putting only a temporary dent in currency gains. Indian rates rally 1-3bp in a bull-flattening move, supported by [reports](#) that the RBI is conducting FX swaps to manage liquidity in the system, which stands at a surplus of around INR1.2tr. Meanwhile, Indonesia lags regional peers, with IDR strengthening just 0.2% even as local rates outperform (10y: -5bp).
- **LatAm currencies rebound in line with global risk appetite, while LatAm**

rates outperform US Treasuries. As the US **considers** doubling aid for Argentina to \$40bn, Argentine bonds and equities (MERVAL: +1.5%) rise, but USD/ARS gains 0.4% despite another US **purchase** of ARS. Most other regional currencies trade stronger against the dollar, with Colombia leading gains (USD/COP: -0.8%). Colombia's IBR curve also sees the most pronounced bull-flattening, with long-end yields falling nearly 10bps as production and sales prints come in softer than expected.

Central Bank Monitor

Developed Markets

- **Fed Governor Miran highlighted** emerging risks to the economic outlook stemming from China's rare earth export controls. He noted that inflation is trending back toward 2%, with substantial disinflation expected within a year. Miran added that trade uncertainty increases the urgency for Fed rate cuts and emphasized that US-China trade tensions pose significant downside risks. He said lower immigration is unlikely to create wage pressures and stressed the need for fair treatment of all policies in inflation analysis.
- **Fed Governor Waller said** AI is expected to boost GDP and national income, though job gains may take a few more years due to the rapid pace of development. He emphasized that disruption is necessary to unlock technological benefits and advocated continued investment in AI, though it primarily enhances productivity.
- **ECB Governing Council Member Nagel said** there are currently no grounds to change interest rates, emphasizing the need for vigilance regarding inflation risks.
- **RBA Governor Bullock described** the RBA's current monetary policy as "marginally tight."
- **RBA Assistant Governor Kent** said that the drag from tight financial conditions is easing, helping the economy stay near full employment with inflation returning to target.
- **RBA Assistant Governor Hunter said** Australia's underlying inflation in the three months through September will likely be stronger than the RBA had anticipated.
- **ECB Governing Council Member Muller said** that inflation risks are more or less balanced, but China's export controls could be inflationary.
- **ECB Governing Council Member Villeroy** reiterated that the ECB's next move is more likely to be a cut than a hike.

Exhibit 1: G4 Rates Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US			Germany			UK			Japan		
	15-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	15-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	15-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	15-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
2y	3.497	1.7		1.919	(1.3)		3.892	(0.3)		0.894	1.1	
3y	3.500	1.1		1.979	(2.5)		3.881	(2.1)		0.980	0.2	
5y	3.616	0.9		2.164	(3.6)		3.999	(3.7)		1.187	1.2	
7y	3.803	0.5		2.305	(3.7)		4.136	(4.2)		1.411	1.1	
10y	4.028	(0.4)		2.570	(3.9)		4.542	(4.8)		1.647	(0.1)	
20y	4.593	(0.1)		3.047	(4.4)		5.230	(5.3)		2.693	(1.5)	
30y	4.625	(0.7)		3.145	(4.6)		5.342	(5.1)		3.165	(4.7)	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Inflation Closes (5pm NY)

US TIPS				10y Real Yields, BEI			
Tenor	15-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	15-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
5y	1.231	1.6		DBRi	0.618	(2.8)	
BEI	2.356	(0.9)		BEI	1.741	(1.0)	
10y	1.725	0.2		UKTi	1.564	(2.7)	
BEI	2.300	(0.7)		BEI	3.049	(2.3)	
30y	2.403	(0.3)		JGBi	-0.001	(1.4)	
BEI	2.223	(0.4)		BEI	1.620	1.6	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: Macro Closes (5pm NY)

Majors				EM				Equities / Commodities			
Spot	15-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk	Spot	15-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk	Index	15-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk
DXY	98.79	(0.3)		CNH	7.13	(0.1)		S&P	6671.06	0.4	
EUR	1.165	0.3		INR	88.07	(0.8)		Stoxx	5605.03	1.0	
GBP	1.340	0.6		THB	32.55	(0.7)		FTSE	9424.75	(0.3)	
JPY	151.05	(0.5)		KRW	1422.50	(0.4)		Nikkei	47672.67	1.8	
CHF	0.797	(0.5)		ZAR	17.35	(0.2)		VIX	20.64	(0.8)	
AUD	0.651	0.4		MXN	18.46	(0.2)		Gold (S)	4207.48	1.6	
CAD	1.404	(0.0)		BRL	5.45	(0.5)		WTI (Fut)	58.27	(0.7)	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: G4 Central Bank Implied Pricing

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Fed				ECB				BOE			
Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ		Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	
EFFR (10/14)	4.100	0.0	—	EONIA (10/14)	1.927	0.0	—	SONIA (10/14)	3.967	0.0	—
10/29/25	3.862	(0.0)	(23.8)	10/30/25	1.921	0.2	(0.6)	11/06/25	3.936	0.1	(3.1)
12/10/25	3.630	1.3	(47.0)	12/18/25	1.895	0.6	(3.2)	12/18/25	3.871	(0.1)	(9.7)
01/28/26	3.493	0.5	(60.7)	02/05/26	1.877	1.1	(5.0)	02/05/26	3.728	(1.6)	(23.9)
03/18/26	3.366	1.0	(73.4)	03/19/26	1.828	1.4	(9.9)	03/19/26	3.694	(0.8)	(27.3)
04/29/26	3.293	1.0	(80.7)	04/30/26	1.804	1.1	(12.3)	04/30/26	3.596	(0.3)	(37.1)
06/17/26	3.148	0.8	(95.2)	06/11/26	1.771	(0.6)	(15.6)	06/18/26	3.560	(1.6)	(40.7)

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

The Day Ahead*Developed Markets*

- 7:00am BST - **UK August Monthly GDP** (MSe: 0.1% m/m; C: 0.1%; P: 0.0%)
- 7:00am BST - **UK August Index of Services** (MSe: 0.1% m/m; C: 0.1% m/m; P: 0.1%)
- 7:00am BST - **UK August Industrial Production** (MSe: 0.0% m/m; C: 0.2%; P: -0.9%)
- 2:00pm BST - **ECB Governing Council Member Wunsch** will speak in Washington
- 4:45pm BST - **ECB Chief Economist Lane** will speak in Washington
- 5:00pm BST - **ECB President Lagarde** will speak in Washington
- 8:30am EST - **US October Philadelphia Fed Business Outlook** (C: 10; P: 23.2). We anticipate a moderation in October's Philly Fed Manufacturing Index following September's sharp rebound to +23.2 from -0.3 in August — the highest reading since January. That surge signaled a notable recovery in regional manufacturing activity, making a pullback or normalization in the upcoming release a reasonable expectation
- 8:30am EST - **US October New York Fed Services Business Activity** (P: -19.4). September's headline index fell to -19.4, the weakest reading since April and the seventh consecutive monthly contraction in New York State's service sector. The persistent decline underscores ongoing challenges facing service firms, and we expect this weakness to extend into October

- 10:00am EST - **US October NAHB Housing Market Index** (C: 33; P: 32). Points to ongoing weakness in single-family building
- 9:00am EST - **Fed Governor Barr** and **Fed Governor Miran** will speak
- 10:00am EST - **Fed Vice Chair for Supervision Bowman** will speak at the Stress Testing Research Conference
- 6:00pm EST - **Minneapolis Fed President Kashkari** will speak in South Dakota
- 8:30pm ET - **Australia September Employment Change** (MSe: 30.0K; C: 20.0K; P: -5.4K); **Unemployment Rate** (MSe: 4.2%; C: 4.3%; P: 4.2%) & **Participation Rate** (MSe: 66.8%; C: 66.8%; P: 66.8%)

Emerging Markets

- Thu 11:00am HKT - **Korea September Total Bank Lending to Household** (P: KRW1168.3tr)
- 8:00am EST - **Brazil August Economic Activity** (P: 1.15% y/y; C: 0.70%). Markets expect a deceleration in economic activity, but fiscal concerns remain elevated

Economic Releases

Developed Markets

- **US October Empire Manufacturing:** 10.7 (C: -1.8; P: -8.7). A healthy rebound in October after a month of weakness at -8.7 and +11.9 in the prior two months. On an ISM-adjusted basis, it read 52.7 — above trend and approaching recent highs. Solid sign for October manufacturing, but it's only the first of the regional surveys and can be noisy from month to month.
- **US Fed October 2025 Beige Book:** Overall economic activity remained largely unchanged, mirroring the tone of the September release. However, price pressures intensified, with several districts noting faster input cost increases — particularly from imports — and more firms in manufacturing and retail passing these costs on to consumers.
- **Sweden September Final CPIF-ex Energy:** 2.7% y/y (MSe: 2.7%; C: 2.7%; P: 2.7%); **Final CPIF:** 3.1% y/y (MSe: 3.1%; C: 3.1%; P: 3.1%) & **Final CPI:** 0.9% y/y (MSe: 0.9%; C: 0.9%; P: 0.9%)
- **Euro Area August Industrial Production ex Construction:** -1.2% m/m (MSe: -3.1%; C: -1.8%; P: 0.3%). The decline was milder than expected.

Emerging Markets

- **China September Headline CPI:** -0.3% y/y (MSe: -0.2% y/y; C: -0.2%; P: -0.4%); **Core CPI:** 1.0% y/y (MSe: 0.9% y/y; P: 0.9%) & **PPI:** -2.3% y/y (MSe: -2.2% y/y; C: -2.3%; P: -2.9%)
- **China September New TSF:** RMB3534bn (MSe: RMB3150bn; C: RMB3349bn; P: RMB2567bn); **New CNY Loans:** RMB1290bn (MSe: RMB1450bn; C: RMB1460bn; P: RMB589bn) & **M2 Money Supply:** 8.4% y/y (MSe: 8.5%; C: 8.5%; P: 8.8%)
- **Korea August M2 Money Supply:** 1.3% m/m (P: 0.8%)
- **Indonesia August External Debt:** \$431.9bn (P: \$430.8bn)

- **Philippines August Overseas Cash Remittances:** 3.2% y/y (C: 2.9%; P: 3.0%)
- **India September Trade Balance:** -\$32.2bn (C: -\$27.5bn; P: -\$26.5bn); **Exports:** 6.7% y/y (P: 6.7%) & **Imports:** 16.7% y/y (P: -10.1%); **Unemployment Rate:** 5.2% (P: 5.1%)
- **Brazil August Retail Sales:** 0.4% y/y (P: 1.0%; C: 0.2%). Retail sales slowed, though the decline was milder than consensus expectations. The government continues to face setbacks in advancing revenue-raising measures and is debating new proposals to offset a projected deficit. Markets are pricing in roughly 4bps of additional cuts for the remainder of 2025, and about 225bps of easing from 2026 through mid-2027, with the terminal rate near 12.62%
- **Colombia August Retail Sales:** 12.4% y/y (P: 17.9%; C: 13.4%). A larger deceleration in retail sales compared to consensus, and fiscal concerns continue to linger. Markets are currently pricing in ~3bps of cuts for the remainder of this year and ~47bps between 2026 and early 2027, with a projected terminal rate near 8.76%

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G4 Smarter (Beta) Trading Partners

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Since 2000, enhancements to a G4 10y government bond futures momentum strategy have produced higher Sharpe ratios and stronger returns relative to total return government bond indices for the G4: US, Germany, Japan, and the UK. See [A "Smarter" \(Beta\) Way to Trade G4 10y Futures Duration?](#) for more information on these strategies.

Exhibit 5: Trading Signals for G4 Smarter (beta) Trading Strategy

Current Risk, G4 10y Futures	G4 Strategy Weight	Trade Longs Portfolio	Fade Shorts Portfolio	Total Risk Trade Longs Only	Total Risk Trade Longs/Fade Shorts (max 200%)	Trade Longs Portfolio Entry Date	Trade Longs Portfolio Exit Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Entry Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Exit Date
J8 10y Future	32.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/20/2025	9/19/2025	10/28/2025
GE 10y Future	29.25%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/7/2025	11/11/2025	9/15/2025	10/20/2025
US 10y Future	30.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/14/2025	11/19/2025	9/24/2025	10/30/2025
UK 10y Future	7.75%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/19/2025	9/25/2025	10/30/2025

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Trading Strategy 1 – "Trade Longs/Fade Shorts"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract and hold for a 25-business-day period. In short, this strategy buys futures when the Simple Moving Average Crossover (SMAX) generates both a long and a short signal, given the historical outperformance of long signals traded long and the underperformance of short signals traded short. Given that the SMAX could generate both a long and a short signal within the predefined holding period, an investor may have a 200% long position since each of the two signals would be traded in separate portfolio sleeves.

Trading Strategy 2 – Trade "Longs Only"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, do nothing. In short, an investor *only* trades long signals initiated by the SMAX given their historical precedent to outperform.

US Holiday Trading Strategy

Currently Active Strategies

None.

Combining the individual trading signals based on 10y Treasury future (TY) price patterns before and after US holidays has generated an annual strategy with no down years since 1987. See [Trading 10y Treasury Futures Around US Holidays](#) for more information.

Using historical data since 1983, we created a trading strategy using 10y Treasury futures (TY) that trades 11 times per year, either long or short, before or after the following US holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, Presidents' Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Columbus Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas. [Exhibit 6](#) displays the trading rules:

Exhibit 6: Trading rules for US holiday trading model using US 10y futures contracts (TY)

Holiday	Day of Week	Direction	Before/After Holiday	Trading Rule (business days, 3pm NY unless specified)	Trade Entry (business days)	Trade Exit (business days)
New Year's Day	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY New Years +1, Sell TY New Years +4	New Year + 1	New Year + 4
Martin Luther King Day 1	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Tuesday before MLK, Sell Friday before MLK	MLK - 4	MLK - 1
Martin Luther King Day 2	Monday	Short TY	After	Sell TY Tuesday after MLK, Buy Friday after MLK	MLK + 1	MLK + 4
President's Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Pres. Day, Sell TY Friday after Pres. Day	Pres. Day + 1	Pres. Day + 4
Good Friday	Friday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Monday after Good Friday, Sell TY Friday after Good Friday	Good Friday + 1	Good Friday + 5
Memorial Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Mem. Day, Sell TY Friday after Mem. Day	Mem. Day + 1	Mem. Day + 4
Independence Day (July 4th)	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY Independence Day + 2, Sell TY Independence Day + 4	Ind. Day + 2	Ind. Day + 4
Labor Day	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Monday before Labor Day, Sell TY Thursday before Labor Day	Labor Day - 4	Labor Day - 2
Columbus Day	Monday	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Monday before Col. Day, Buy TY Thursday before Col. Day	Colum. Day - 5	Colum. Day - 2
Thanksgiving	Thursday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Friday before Thanksgiving, Sell TY Tuesday before Thanksgiving	Thanksgiving - 4	Thanksgiving - 2
Christmas	Rotates	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Christmas Day - 4, Buy TY Christmas Day - 1	Christmas - 4	Christmas - 1

Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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(as of September 30, 2025)

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	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
Stock Rating Category	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1499	41%	389	46%	26%	702	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1618	44%	375	44%	23%	782	45%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	577	16%	88	10%	15%	234	14%
Total	3,698		853			1719	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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